

Ogasawara Fishing Guide

VIP Fishing Hospitality Operations Manual.

CONFIDENTIAL — AIBOS TEAM USE ONLY

LOCATION

Hahajima, Ogasawara Islands

DATE

June 2026

STANDARD

AIBOS / AEGIS

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PART 1

Welcome to the Water

Umi e Youkoso

1.1 You Are an Angler

You are not a spectator. You are not a passenger. From the moment you step onto that boat or walk across those rocks, you are an angler — and that word carries weight. An angler reads the water, respects the ocean, anticipates what comes next, and moves with purpose. On this trip, you are also something more: you are a hospitality professional who happens to be holding a fishing rod.

This guide will teach you everything you need to know. When you are standing on volcanic rock in 30-degree heat with a rod in one hand and a net in the other, you will not have time to look things up. Your preparation is your lifeline.

1.2 Ogasawara: Your Fishing Ground

The Ogasawara Islands sit roughly 1,000 km south of Tokyo — a UNESCO World Heritage site of volcanic islands surrounded by some of the most productive fishing waters in Japan. You will be based on Hahajima.

OGASAWARA IN JUNE	CONDITION
Air	26–30°C, extreme humidity
Ocean	25–27°C
UV	Extreme
Currents	Strong near reefs
Resupply	ZERO — ferry 1–2×/week
Medical evacuation	Near-impossible. Nearest hospital: 24-hour boat ride

1.3 Your Mission: VIP Fishing Hospitality

You work for AIBOS under AEGIS standards. Perfection is the baseline. Nobody stands idle. Your mission: ensure Watanabe-san, Nagatani-san, and guests have an extraordinary fishing experience — lines baited, drinks full, gear maintained, safety constant.

1.4 How to Use This Guide

Ten parts plus appendices. Parts 1–2: mindset. Parts 3–4: tackle and skills. Part 5: fishing scenarios. Parts 6–7: VIP care and gear maintenance. Parts 8–9: safety and rules. Part 10: training. Appendices: laminate-ready reference cards. Read front to back, then keep it close.

PART 2

Your Mindset — 6 Principles

Kodo Gensoku

Memorize these six principles. They apply everywhere — fishing, serving, packing, standing on the dock.

#1 Act Ahead, Never Stand Idle *Sakimawari Suru*

Never wait for instructions. Bait the hook, refill the drink, ready the net, check the drag — before anyone asks. No idle time. Ever.

#2 Keep VIPs First *VIP Saiyusen*

Strict hierarchy: Watanabe > Nagatani > guests > AEGIS. Service order, line attention, shade, first drink. Track their state at all times.

#3 Don't Be the Bottleneck *Nagare wo Tomenai*

Retie fast. Net instantly. Reel in when someone nearby hooks up. Respond to the captain immediately. Never make everyone wait.

#4 Safety Overrides Everything *Anzen ga Subete ni Yusen*

Dangerous environments everywhere. If unsafe, stop. No fish is worth an injury. Overrides all other principles.

#5 Protect Your Gear *Dougu wo Mamore*

No tackle shop on Hahajima. Break it = done. Retie before it frays, rinse after sessions, avoid snags, protect from impacts.

#6 Show Energy and Fun *Genki to Tanoshisa*

Hospitality atmosphere = your behavior. Be visibly positive and energetic. Enthusiasm for every catch.

PART 3

Know Your Tackle

Tsuri Dougu wo Shiru

Everything here is for subtropical saltwater on volcanic island terrain.

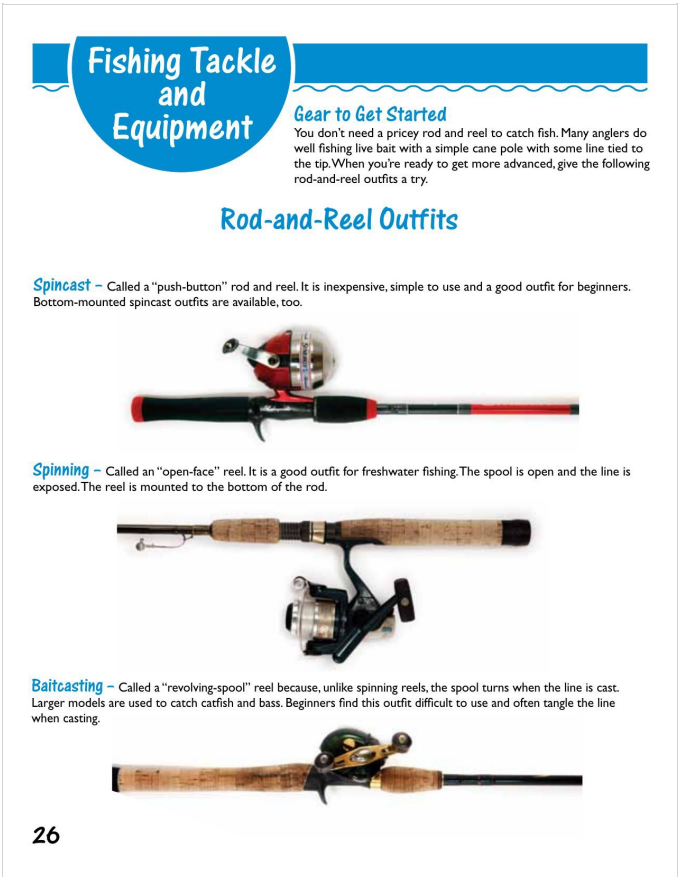


Fig 3.1 — Rod-reel outfits: spincast (top), spinning (middle), baitcasting (bottom). You will primarily use spinning and conventional.

3.1 Rods

TYPE	USE	FEATURE
Iso (II)	Rock fishing	Long 4–5 m, flexible tip, strong butt
Jigging	Offshore	Short 1.5–1.8 m, stiff, for heavy jigs
Light	Port / sanbashi	Medium, versatile

3.2 Reels

- **Spinning** — Fixed spool, bail arm. Mounts below the rod. Easy to cast. For iso, sanbashi, sabiki.
- **Conventional** — Rotating spool. More power. Mounts on top. For jigging at depth. Always set the drag before you drop.

PROTECT YOUR GEAR

Never let a reel touch the gunwale, ground, or sand. No replacements on Hahajima.

3.3 Hooks, Weights & Terminal Tackle

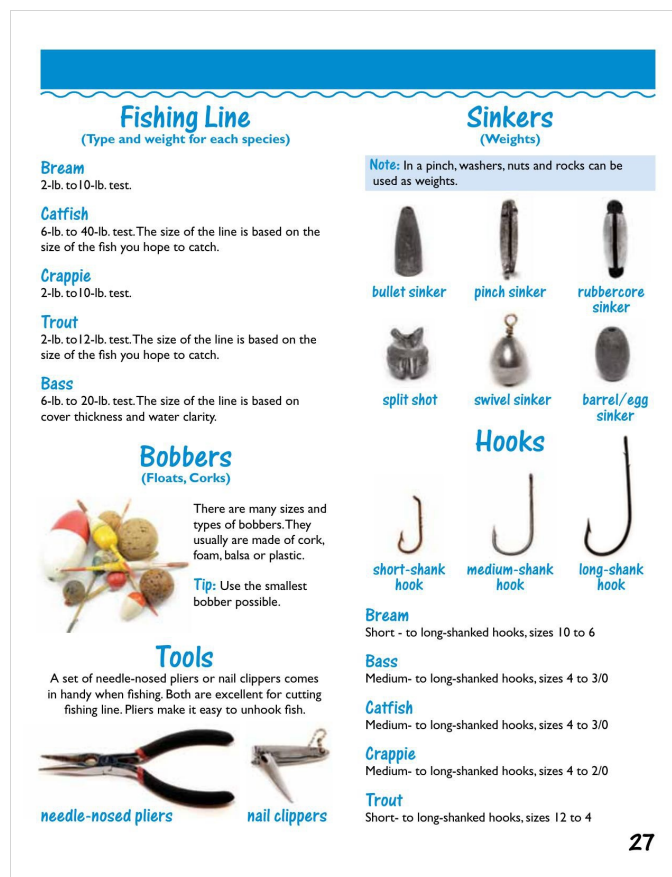


Fig 3.2 — Hooks, sinkers (bullet, split shot, barrel / swivel), and tools.

- **Hooks** — Various sizes, barbed. Handle with care.
- **Sinkers** — Take bait down. Heavier for depth.
- **Swivels / split rings** — Prevent line twist. Essential for jigging.
- **Sabiki rigs** — Multi-hook rigs for catching baitfish at port.

3.4 Lines

TYPE	PROPERTIES	USE
Mono (Nylon)	Stretchy, forgiving	Leader, light rigs
Braided (PE)	Zero stretch, thin, strong	Main line for jigging
Fluorocarbon	Invisible, abrasion-resistant	Leader to hook / lure

PE #3 AT DEPTH

At 250+ meters for Onaga, thinner PE cuts the current better. Less margin for error — knots must be perfect.

3.5 Knots You Must Know

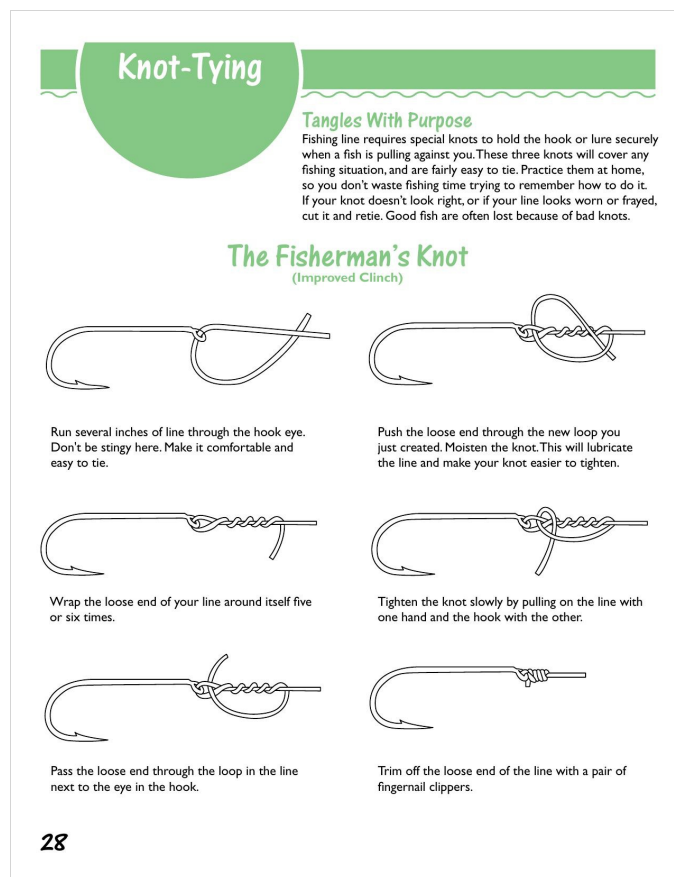


Fig 3.3 — The Improved Clinch Knot. Practice until under 30 seconds.

- **FG Knot** — Braid to leader. ~100% strength. Passes through the guides.
- **Improved Clinch** — Hook / sinker attachment. Thread, wrap 5–6×, moisten, pull.
- **Train Knot** — Line-to-line. Each wraps the other 5×, slide together.

3.6 Saltwater Baits

No bait shop. Securing bait is one of your most important skills.

BAIT	SOURCE	CATCHES
Black crab	Net at port	Reef fish
Small aji	Sabiki rig	Live bait for predators
Muroaji	Pre-supplied	Groupers, trevally, snappers
Sea urchin	From rocks	Ishigakidai
Squid	Pre-supplied	General reef

3.7 Lures and Jigs

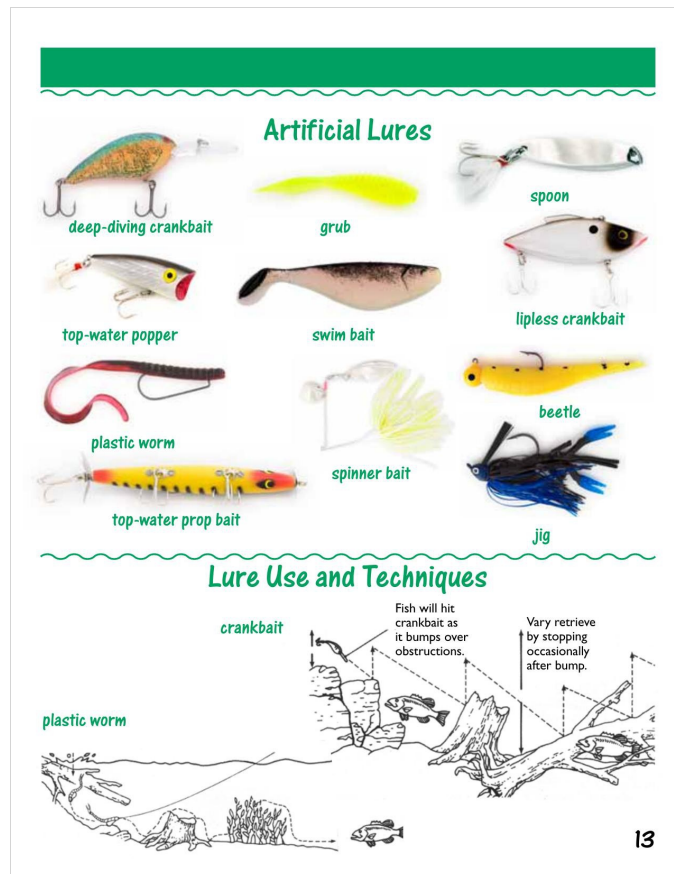


Fig 3.4 — Artificial lures. On Ogasawara: metal jigs, inchiku jigs, soft plastics.

- **Metal jigs (300 g+)** — Deep water. Expensive. Snag = major loss.
- **Inchiku jigs** — Octopus-skirt hybrid. Groupers on shallow reefs.
- **Soft plastic worms** — Akahata and Kappore near reef structure.

3.8 Clothing and Protective Gear

- **UV long-sleeve** — You burn in minutes.
- **Hat + polarized sunglasses**
- **Iso boots (II)** — Spiked / felt sole. Regular shoes = fatal.
- **Life jacket** — Mandatory.
- **Gloves** — PE line cuts to bone.
- **Eye protection** — Mandatory for jigging.

Essential Skills

Kihon Sukiru

4.1 Casting

Overhead Cast

Primary cast. Rod at 2 o'clock, smooth forward to 10, release. Practice until fluid.

Roll Cast

No room behind you. Sweep the rod up and forward; the line rolls out. Less distance, safer.

Underhand Pitch

Short, precise. Hold the lure, open the bail, swing forward. Quiet and accurate for iso bait.

4.2 Jigging — Drop, Bail, Reel, Pitch

- **DROP** — Open the bail. Watch the line. Stops early = bottom or fish.
- **BAIL** — Line slack = close the bail IMMEDIATELY.
- **REEL 8-10** — Aggressive turns off the bottom. Non-negotiable. Saves your jig.
- **PITCH** — Pump the rod up, reel down. The jig darts like wounded prey.
- **REPEAT** — Captain says up = reel fast. Don't wait.

THE 8-10 REEL RULE

Snag = lost jig + everyone stops. The 8-10 reel rule is insurance. Every time.

4.3 Sabiki Rig Fishing

Drop to mid-water, jig gently. Multiple fish hook at once. Transfer to a bucket with fresh seawater.

4.4 Baiting

- **Crab** — Large: split, hook through the body. Small: hook through the rear shell.
- **Live aji** — Hook through the back or nose. Keep alive.
- **Cut muroaji** — Strips, thread the hook through twice.
- **Sea urchin** — Crush, scoop the flesh, mold on the hook. Scatter shells first.

4.5 Fighting and Landing

Fish bites: set the hook — firm upward sweep. Fight: rod at 45 degrees, pump and reel. Never reel against a running drag.

Groupers dive for the reef immediately. You have 2 seconds to force them up or the line breaks.

Netting: always head-first. On iso, position securely. On a boat, step back from the rail.

4.6 Hook Removal

Pliers. Always. Barbed hooks go through skin easily. Isomaguro has razor teeth. Aochibiki is slimy — use a glove.

4.7 Quick Retying

Lost hooks, snapped lines — every second a VIP waits with bare line is a failure. 60 seconds max. Practice wet, standing, in wind.

PART 5

Fishing Scenarios

Tsuri no Bamen

Every session = one of three scenarios. Know them cold.

5.1 Port / Sanbashi (II)

Dock / seawall fishing. Bait-gathering operation + relaxed VIP fishing.

Gear

- Cigarettes + drinks
- Rain cover
- Scissors / clippers
- Small rods + reels + sabiki + sinkers
- Long net + bucket + fish bag + headlight

Tasks

Primary: secure bait. Crabs by net, aji by sabiki. Manage the bait bucket.

Behaviors

- Check Watanabe-san. Offer drinks proactively.
- Net ready on hookup. Assist hook removal.
- Retie lost rigs fast.
- Stay together. Energy. Tidy area.

5.2 Iso / Rock Fishing (I)

MOST DANGEROUS SCENARIO

Read every word. The boat drops you on a volcanic reef for 5–6 hours. No return. Bait + lure fishing.

Rock Transfer

- 01 Life jackets ON before reaching the rock.
- 02 One person at a time. Captain's signal.
- 03 STEP — don't jump — at the top of the swell.
- 04 Hands free. Gear passed by relay.
- 05 Check footing before putting weight down.
- 06 Return is MORE dangerous. Same discipline.

Safety

- Watch your feet. Don't walk backward or look at your phone.
- Never turn your back to the sea. Waves come in sets. Know your retreat spot.
- Gear in spray-free spots. Nothing loose near the edges.

Long Haul

6 hours, 30°C, no shade, no escape. Drink constantly. Electrolytes. Watch Watanabe-san for heat exhaustion. Everything you need = brought with you.

VIP Care

- Secure bait. Retie fast. Drinks + cigarettes.
- Net on hookup — critical on bad footing.
- Net head-first. Bait your own hook. Show energy.

5.3 Jigging / Offshore (III)

Deep-water from a boat. 100–200 m depth. Big fish: Kanpachi, tuna, deep snappers.

Gear

- Jigging rods + reels
- Tackle + pliers + GLOVES
- Cooler with drinks
- EYE PROTECTION

Rules

- **Set drag** — Before every drop.
- **Watch line** — Stops = bottom or fish.
- **8–10 reels** — Off the bottom. Saves the jig.
- **Space out** — Don't crowd. Ready to move.
- **Slow retrieve** — When the jig is visible. Flying jig = danger.
- **Reel up fast** — When someone nearby hooks up.
- **Hold jigs** — Never let them swing free.
- **Step back** — From the rail when a fish surfaces.
- **Obey the captain** — Instantly. No delays.
- **Call out** — "Coming through!" Always.
- **BE READY** — At all times.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

No bare hands on PE under tension. Gloves. No reel on the gunwale.

PART 6

Taking Care of Your VIPs

VIP no Kea

6.1 The Hierarchy

PRIORITY	PERSON	RESPONSIBILITY
1st	Watanabe-san	Everything first.
2nd	Nagatani-san	Immediately after.
3rd	Guests	Any invited.
4th	Other AEGIS	You eat / drink / sit last.

6.2 Watanabe-san

- Forks prongs-down at meals.
- Beach chair at all locations.
- Heat exhaustion: #1 monitoring priority.
- Seasickness: private cabin + meds + cup ramen + snacks.
- Cigarettes + drinks: never let them run out.

6.3 Nagatani-san

- Likes sweets. Reserved bar seat on the ship.

6.4 On-Water Comfort

Read body language. Focused = nearby but don't hover. Resting = offer a drink. Fish on = net ready before they look.

PART 7

Tackle Care and Cleaning

Dougu no Teire

7.1 *Why Saltwater Destroys Gear*

Salt corrodes metal in hours. Sand grinds bearings. UV weakens mono. Your gear must last 10 days. Cleaning = survival.

7.2 *Post-Session Rinse*

- 01 Rinse rods — focus on the guides.
- 02 Rinse reels gently. No submersion, no pressure.
- 03 Back off all drags.
- 04 Rinse hooks / lures / jigs. Dry before storing.
- 05 Wipe handles and reel seats.
- 06 Stand rods upright or flat.

7.3 *Reel Maintenance*

- **Bail** — Clean snap open / close.
- **Drag** — Smooth turning. Gritty = salt inside.
- **Spool** — Check the line for nicks.
- **Handle** — Smooth. Grinding = alert the leader.

7.4 *Hook & Lure Care*

- Rinse, dry, dry container.
- Thumbnail sharpness test.
- Check split rings and assist hooks.

7.5 *Line Inspection*

Run your fingers along the first 10 m. Cut back past damage. Cloudy mono = replace. Fuzzy braid = re-spool.

7.6 *Storage*

- Out of sunlight.
- Bails open, drags off.
- Air-dry tackle boxes.
- Never store wet gear in closed bags overnight.

PART 8

Safety and Emergency

Anzen to Kinkyu Taio

8.1 The Hahajima Reality

PREVENTION IS THE ONLY STRATEGY

No hospital. Ferry 1–2×/week. No cell signal. YOU are the first responder.

8.2 Emergency Roles

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
1. Scene Leader	Takes command.
2. Captain Contact	Comms with Nobu / Hara.
3. Recorder / Interpreter	Documents. Bridges EN / JP.
4. VIP Attendant	Stays with the VIPs.

8.3 Man Overboard

DO NOT JUMP IN.

- 01 Throw a buoyant object / rope.
- 02 Contact the captain.
- 03 Point continuously.

8.4 Injuries

- **Fracture** — Don't move. Warm. Stop bleeding. Share severity.
- **Hook** — Don't force out. Stabilize. Medical judgment.
- **Laceration** — Direct pressure.

8.5 Heat Exhaustion

#1 iso risk. Heavy sweating, nausea, dizziness. Sweating STOPS = heat stroke = emergency. Shade + cool water on neck / armpits + rehydrate. Watch Watanabe-san.

8.6 Dangerous Marine Life

No bare hands. Gonzui (venomous spines), Utsubo (moray), Gangaze (sea urchin), Isomaguro (razor teeth).

CIGUATERA — BARAFUEDAI

Some carry toxin. Odorless, tasteless, heat-stable. Tingling + temperature reversal hours later. If in doubt, don't eat.

8.7 Communication

Hand signs finalized in training Block 3: Fish on / Reel up / Coming through / Stop / Emergency. Don't carry it alone. Share immediately. VIP safety > catch.

Dos and Don'ts

Yarubeki / Yatte wa Ikenai

9.1 Universal Dos

- Life jacket on the boat + rocks.
- Set the drag before dropping.
- Rinse gear after every session.
- Carry Watanabe-san's items.
- Know the first-aid location.
- Retie worn line.
- Call out when passing behind.
- Net head-first.
- Respond to the captain instantly.
- Share problems — never alone.

9.2 Universal Don'ts

- Turn your back to the sea.
- Jump during the transfer.
- Carry gear during the transfer.
- Let a jig swing free.
- Handle PE without gloves.
- Touch creatures bare-handed.
- Force barbed hooks out.
- Hit the reel on the gunwale.
- Stand idle.
- Let VIP supplies run out.
- Walk backward on the rocks.
- Use your phone while walking terrain.

PART 10

Pre-Trip Training

Shuppatsu Mae Kunren

10.1 Timeline (June 9–18)

DATES	BLOCK	CONTENT
Jun 9–11	Fundamentals	Knots, baiting, rigging. Knots first.
Jun 12–15	Behaviors	Sanbashi / Jigging / Iso drills + Serving
Jun 16–17	Rehearsal	Hand signs + Emergency scenarios
Jun 18	Pre-Departure	Safety briefing + dry run + packing
Jun 19	DEPARTURE	—

10.2 Skill Assignments

Each person masters one skill, then teaches the team. Assignments by Matsumoto + Nate.

10.3 Final Briefing (June 18)

Full safety briefing + physical rock-transfer practice on land + final packing check against the inventory.

APPENDICES

Reference Cards

Laminate-ready

A. Master Gear Checklist

PORT

- ☐ Cigarettes + lighter
- ☐ Drinks
- ☐ Rain cover
- ☐ Scissors
- ☐ Small rods + reels
- ☐ Sabiki + sinkers
- ☐ Long net
- ☐ Bucket w/ rope
- ☐ Fish bag
- ☐ Headlight

ISO

- ☐ Cigarettes + lighter
- ☐ Drinks (6+ hrs)
- ☐ Chair / pad
- ☐ Iso rod + reel + tackle + bait
- ☐ LIFE JACKET
- ☐ Lunch + electrolytes
- ☐ Sunscreen + hat + UV
- ☐ Net
- ☐ First-aid kit

JIGGING

- ☐ Jigging rods + reels
- ☐ Tackle + pliers
- ☐ GLOVES
- ☐ Cooler + drinks
- ☐ EYE PROTECTION
- ☐ LIFE JACKET
- ☐ First-aid kit

B. Knot Quick Reference

KNOT	STEPS
FG Knot	Loop leader, weave braid 15–20×. Half-hitch 6× alternating. Trim. Must pass the guides.
Improved Clinch	Thread eye 6 in. Wrap 5–6×. Through the small loop then the big loop. Moisten, pull, trim.
Train Knot	Overlap 15 cm. A wraps B 5×, thread. B wraps A 5×, thread. Moisten, slide together, trim.

C. Hand Signals

SIGNAL	MEANING
Fist pump up	Fish on!
Circular wind	Reel up
Palm forward	Stop / Hold
Arm wave	Emergency
Point + tap shoulder	Coming through

D. Emergency Card (Laminate)

SITUATION	ACTION
Man Overboard	Don't jump. Throw float. Contact captain. Point.
Fracture	Don't move. Warm. Stop bleeding. Share.
Hook	Don't force. Stabilize. Medical.
Heat	Shade. Cool. Rehydrate. Stroke if no sweat.
Creature	No bare hands. Clean. Pressure. Medical.

E. Tackle Cleaning Checklist

DAILY

- ☐ Rods rinsed
- ☐ Guides inspected
- ☐ Reels rinsed gently
- ☐ Drags backed off
- ☐ Hooks / lures dried
- ☐ Line inspected 10 m
- ☐ Handles wiped

You have read the guide. You know the principles, tackle, skills, scenarios, and rules. Now train, practice, prepare. When you step onto Hahajima, you will be ready.

Good luck, angler. Ganbatte.